

SUMMIT TUITION ASSESSMENT

COMPREHENSION TECHNIQUE-SPOTTING*Practice Paper — For Changlun***Instructions to candidates**

- Read the passage carefully. Paragraphs are numbered for reference.
- Answer ALL questions in the spaces provided — most questions ask you to name a technique AND justify it with evidence.
- Some questions require you to combine information from more than one paragraph.

Candidate name: Changlun

Date

THE UNDERSTUDY*Read the following extract, then answer the questions that follow.*

- 1 Tobias had learned every line of the part in six days, which nobody had asked him to do. He was the understudy for Mr. Farrow's role in the school's production of "The Long Winter," a part he had never expected to actually play, and he told himself the memorising was simply good practice.
- 2 Mr. Farrow's cough had started during the second week of rehearsals and had, by the third, become a running joke among the cast — he'd wave it off between scenes, insisting it was "just the chalk dust" from the set-painting. The director, Ms. Okonkwo, stopped laughing along by the fourth week. She began rehearsing the final scene twice each session: once with Farrow, and once, quietly, with Tobias standing in his mark.
- 3 Nobody told Tobias this was anything other than standard understudy practice. He noticed, all the same, that his rehearsals with Ms. Okonkwo had started running fifteen minutes longer than they used to, and that she had begun correcting details — the exact angle of a turn, the beat before a line — that she had never bothered with when he was simply covering for an absent actor on a normal day.
- 4 Three nights before opening, Farrow missed rehearsal entirely. Ms. Okonkwo told the cast he had "a family matter," delivered in the same flat, rehearsed tone she used for stage directions. Tobias ran the full final scene alone with her that evening, and for the first time she stopped mid-scene to say, simply, "Good. Do exactly that on the night, whichever night it turns out to be."
- 5 He didn't ask her what she meant. He went home and read the script twice more.

SECTION A — INFERENCE FROM WITHHELD INFORMATION*Definition: working out what a character truly knows or suspects from actions and phrasing, when the passage never states it directly.*

1. Ms. Okonkwo never tells Tobias that Farrow might not perform. Using evidence from at least two paragraphs, explain [2 marks] what she does instead that reveals she expects this.

2. "Whichever night it turns out to be" (paragraph 4) is a deliberately vague phrase. What is Ms. Okonkwo avoiding saying [1 mark] outright?

- That the play has been cancelled
- That she has not decided which actor will perform
- That she expects Tobias, not Farrow, to perform
- That opening night has been postponed

SECTION B — STRUCTURAL PACING (WHAT THE ORDER REVEALS)*Definition: recognising that the order in which a writer reveals events is chosen deliberately, and asking what effect that order has on the reader.*

3. The passage reveals Farrow's cough in paragraph 2, then Ms. Okonkwo's extra rehearsals in the same paragraph, then [2 marks]
reveals in paragraph 3 that Tobias only "noticed" this pattern after it had already been happening. What effect does this delayed
noticing have on how the reader understands Tobias?

4. Which of these statements about the passage's structure is NOT true? [1 mark]

The cough is introduced before its seriousness becomes clear
Tobias's private suspicion is revealed before Ms. Okonkwo's actions that caused it
The final line comes immediately after the most direct hint Ms. Okonkwo gives
Paragraph 5 is deliberately short compared to the paragraphs before it

SECTION C — TONE AND WORD CHOICE

Definition: identifying how a specific word or phrase (not just the general subject) creates a feeling of unease, formality, or distance.

5. "delivered in the same flat, rehearsed tone she used for stage directions" (paragraph 4). Explain what this comparison [2 marks]
suggests about whether Ms. Okonkwo believes her own explanation.

6. Give one word or short phrase from paragraph 3 that shows Tobias's rehearsals were being treated as more important [1 mark]
than ordinary understudy cover.

SECTION D — CROSS-PARAGRAPH SYNTHESIS

Definition: combining a detail from an early paragraph with a detail from a later one to answer a question neither paragraph answers alone.

7. Using evidence from paragraphs 1, 3 and 5 together, explain why Tobias's decision to memorise the part "which nobody [3 marks]
had asked him to do" (paragraph 1) turns out, by the end of the passage, to have been the correct instinct.

8. Is it accurate to say Ms. Okonkwo "told" Tobias he would be performing? Answer using specific evidence, and explain [2 marks]
the difference between telling someone directly and letting them work something out.

MARKING NOTES (FOR THE TUTOR, NOT THE STUDENT)

1. **Q1 (2):** Award 1 mark per paragraph used. Look for: the doubled rehearsal of the final scene (para 2) and the increasingly detailed, longer coaching of Tobias specifically (para 3) — both show she is preparing him as a real contingency, not routine cover.
2. **Q2:** C.
3. **Q3 (2):** Should note that placing Tobias's "noticing" after the pattern already existed shows he is observant but deliberately doesn't ask questions or draw attention to it — reinforcing his quiet, careful characterisation rather than making him seem naive.
4. **Q4:** B (his suspicion is shown through his noticing in para 3, which comes after — not before — Ms. Okonkwo's actions in para 2 that caused it).
5. **Q5 (2):** The comparison to a rehearsed stage direction implies her explanation is itself a performance — practised and hollow — suggesting she does not fully believe the "family matter" cover story either, or expects the cast not to believe it.
6. **Q6:** Accept "fifteen minutes longer," "correcting details," or "never bothered with" — any phrase showing escalated attention/seriousness.
7. **Q7 (3):** Full marks require linking: he memorised early with no instruction (para 1) → this let him meet Ms. Okonkwo's rising, specific demands without needing extra preparation time (para 3) → which meant he was genuinely ready when the moment arrived with no warning (para 5). Award partial credit for using only two of the three paragraphs.
8. **Q8 (2):** No — she never states it. Accept any answer distinguishing implication/preparation (doubled rehearsals, coaching, the final instruction "do exactly that") from an explicit statement, showing understanding that being shown is not the same as being told.